CHARACTER BOOKLET · NO. 12

Perry *Lanthorn*

LANTERN-MAKER WHO LIGHTS THE LANTERN GALLERY

"You light a hundred lanterns every Halloween. Tonight one of them lit itself."



FOR PERRY LANTHORN'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

CORE CHARACTER

IN EVERY GAME

COSTUME FROM YOUR CLOSET

A long coat or raincoat, a woolly scarf and a lantern to carry (a flashlight in a jar works). Pin a paper moth to your shoulder.

Mask: a moth-wing mask cut from brown paper or a grocery bag.

BRING TO THE BALL

- [ ] This booklet, folded shut
- [ ] A pen for your notes
- [ ] Your costume and mask

How this booklet works

Before the ball: read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.

Round 1: the top half of page 3, when the Detective says so.

Round 2: the lower half of page 3, below the cut line.

Costume Parade: strike a pose and stay in character.

Round 3: page 4. Then everyone casts a ballot.

Print this booklet single-sided, or cut page 3 on its dashed line, so later rounds can't show through.

THE BALL

Every Halloween, Vesper Ravensworth opens the old candle works on the hill for the Candlewick Costume Ball. This year Vesper promised "an announcement that will change Candlewick Hollow" at nine o'clock. Before it could be made, Vesper sat down in the window chair of the Lantern Gallery and never woke up. Minutes earlier, guests saw the Lantern Ghost drift past the glass.

Never show this booklet to anyone. Bend the truth about your secret, never the evidence.

You are innocent.

You did not harm Vesper. You may still have something to hide.

BACKGROUND

Last week Vesper told you that when the Hall becomes a museum, the real lanterns in the gallery will be replaced with electric bulbs. Eleven years of lantern nights, gone.

YOUR SECRET

You are the Lantern Ghost, and you have been every Halloween for eleven years: a battery tea light in a tiny lantern, sliding along clear fishing line from window one to window nine, pulled by hand from the terrace. Tonight you flew it one last time, hoping a famous ghost sighting in the Hollow Gazette would save the real lanterns.

WHAT YOU SAY ABOUT TONIGHT

From 8:25 you were on a stepladder on the terrace outside the gallery windows, tying the line (the Gazette camera photographed you at 8:30 and 8:36). Jory was lighting jack-o'-lanterns beside you. At 8:36, through window seven, you saw Vesper sipping from the pumpkin cup, and someone in a long black cloak hurrying away up the gallery toward the Back Stairs. You only saw their back. At 8:48 you flew the ghost.

YOUR GOALS

- Keep the Lantern Ghost secret until Round 3.
- Make sure everyone hears what you saw through window seven.
- Save the real lanterns of the gallery.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

Read each round only when the Detective starts it. Say your Share lines in your own words, ask your two questions and try your task. You may dodge questions about your secret until your booklet tells you to share it, but never lie about what you saw, and never change what an evidence card says.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 1 · *The Grand Entrance*

ROUND 1

Read only when the Detective starts Round 1.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

You were out on the terrace from 8:25, checking the gallery window latches (that is all you will say for now). Jory was there too, lighting the row of jack-o'-lanterns without a mask on. Tell people the Lantern Ghost is real: you have seen it every year for eleven years.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Jory Greaves:** "Did you see anyone go in or out of the gallery while you were lighting pumpkins?"

? Ask **Briar Fallow:** "Which guests wore long black cloaks tonight?"

YOUR TASK

> Persuade one person that the Lantern Ghost is real.

CUT OR FOLD HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE DETECTIVE

Round 2 · *The Lantern Ghost*

ROUND 2

Read only when the Detective starts Round 2.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Yes, you were on a stepladder (Evidence #6). Now share what you saw at 8:36 through window seven: Vesper sipping from the pumpkin cup, and someone in a long black cloak hurrying away up the gallery toward the Back Stairs door. At that moment Hadley stood at the far, ballroom end of the gallery with a notebook. Hadley and the cloak were two different people.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Hadley Cresswell:** "What did the person who carried the cup look like?"

? Ask **Darcy Wickliffe:** "Did Vesper ever mention electric lights for the gallery?"

YOUR TASK

> Keep the ghost secret one more round. Change the subject if anyone waves Evidence #4 or #8 at you.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 3 · *Unmasked*

ROUND 3

Read only when the Detective starts Round 3.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Confess: you are the Lantern Ghost, and have been for eleven years. The fishing line (Evidence #4) and the torn supply slip signed "Pe" (Evidence #8) are yours. Explain why: the real lanterns. The ghost flew at 8:48, after Vesper had already taken the cup. It has nothing to do with what happened to Vesper.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Marlo Quince:** "You hold the workshop keys. Who else uses the Back Stairs door?"

? Ask **Jory Greaves:** "When did you notice that your fox mask was gone?"

YOUR TASK

> Win a round of applause for the Lantern Ghost.

Notes

SUSPECTS AT THE BALL *(public · OPT. = may not be playing)*

10 Marlo Quince · Master Chandler of Candlewick Hall

11 Darcy Wickliffe · Vesper's younger cousin and heir

12 Perry Lanthorn · Lantern-maker who lights the Lantern Gallery

13 Briar Fallow · Costume maker of Candlewick Hollow

14 Jory Greaves · Pumpkin farmer and three-time carving champion

15 Hadley Cresswell · Editor of the Hollow Gazette

16 Auden Pryor (OPT.) · Town historian and keeper of the Lantern Ghost legend

17 Bexley Applegate (OPT.) · Owner of the Applegate cider press

18 Corin Thimble (OPT.) · Fiddler and leader of the ball's band

19 Larkin Hearthstone (OPT.) · Baker of the Candlewick pumpkin pies

20 Teagan Bramwell (OPT.) · Groundskeeper of Candlewick Hall

21 Ainsley Duskwood (OPT.) · Fortune-booth performer (stage act only)

22 Merritt Oxley (OPT.) · Town clerk carrying Vesper's papers

23 Wynn Pennywhistle (OPT.) · Photographer of the Costume Parade